

Week 3 — Pulse Diagnosis

REQUIRED READINGS — DUE BEFORE JULY 25

FCM CHAPTER 25 — MACIOCIA

- The Normal Pulse (平脈 Píng Mài)
- Three essential qualities: 胃神根
- 28 pulse qualities — full descriptions
- Clinical groupings by pattern
- Pulse qualities at individual positions

CAM CHAPTER 13 — CHENG XINNONG

- Normal pulse description
- 28 pathological pulse types
- Yin/Yang classification of pulses
- Pulse-taking method review
- Pulse qualities in disease

WEEK 3 LEARNING OBJECTIVES (CLO 1, 4, 5, 6)

- Describe the characteristics of a normal pulse
- Name the three essential qualities (胃神根) and explain each
- Identify the 28 classical pulse qualities by feel and name
- Classify pulses by Yin/Yang grouping (CAM framework)
- Explain what each pulse quality indicates clinically
- Differentiate easily confused pulse pairs (e.g., Wiry vs Tight)
- Apply pulse findings to the six positions bilaterally
- Integrate pulse with tongue for pattern differentiation

ASSESSMENT CALENDAR

Date	Event	Material Covered
Jul 24	⚠ Quiz 2	Week 2: Four Pillars, 8 Principles, Tongue intro, Pulse intro
Jul 25	Week 3 Class	Normal Pulse, 28 Pulse Qualities, in-class palpation practice
Jul 31	Quiz 3	Week 3 material — Pulse Diagnosis
Aug 7	MIDTERM + Journal 1–25	Weeks 1–4 comprehensive
Sep 11	FINAL + Journal 26–50	Weeks 6–9 comprehensive

IN-CLASS PRACTICE — WHAT TO EXPECT FRIDAY

PALPATION LAB

Week 3 includes hands-on in-class practice on pulse palpation. Come ready to:

- Practice three-finger placement on a partner (Cun/Guan/Chi bilaterally)
- Identify depth levels — superficial, middle, deep
- Attempt to name at least 3–5 qualities you feel in a live practice pulse
- Document your findings in your Pulse/Tongue Journal (entry counts toward midterm)

PRE-LECTURE PREP & QUESTIONS I HAVE GOING IN

AFTER LECTURE — 3 THINGS I WILL REVIEW BEFORE NEXT WEEK

1.

2.

3.

PULSE POSITIONS — 寸關尺 · BOTH HANDS

Hand	Cun 寸 (distal)	Guan 關 (middle)	Chi 尺 (proximal)
Left Heart side	Heart / SM Intestine chest, Pericardium	Liver / Gallbladder	Kidney Yin / Bladder Lower Jiao (L)
Right Lung side	Lung / LG Intestine chest	Spleen / Stomach	Kidney Yang / Bladder Lower Jiao (R)

NORMAL PULSE 平脈 · THREE ESSENTIALS 胃神根

Quality	Normal Finding	Essential	Meaning
Rate	4–5 beats/resp · 72–80 bpm	胃 Wèi	Stomach Qi: flowing, harmonious
Depth	Middle level — not too sup/deep	神 Shén	Spirit: strong, rhythmical
Strength	Forceful but not excessive	根 Gēn	Root: deep at Chi — Kidney Qi
Rhythm	Regular — no skipped beats		

28 PULSE QUALITIES — QUICK REFERENCE · AMERICAN RHYTHM CLINICAL CONNECTIONS IN ITALICS

↑ FLOATING / SUPERFICIAL GROUP				WIDTH / SHAPE / LENGTH GROUP			
浮 Fú	Floating	Exterior / Yin def	post-practice AC chill	弦 Xián	Wiry	Liver · pain · violin string	hip tension, Cuban motion
芤 Kōu	Hollow	Blood/fluid loss		緊 Jīn	Tight	Cold · twisted rope	cramp in Bolero slow
革 Gé	Leather	Jing/Blood loss		滑 Huá	Slippery	Phlegm · pearls rolling	breath/stamina in Swing
散 Sàn	Scattered	Collapsed Qi · critical	overtaining collapse	澀 Sè	Choppy	Blood stasis · scraping	chronic hip socket strain
↓ SINKING / DEEP GROUP				洪 Hóng	Flooding	Excess Heat · surging wave	flushed/sweating at comp
沉 Chén	Deep	Interior		細 Xì	Thin	Blood def · thread	poor stamina after rounds
牢 Láo	Firm	Cold accumulation		濡 Rú	Soggy	Damp · float+thin+soft	
伏 Fú	Hidden	Severe Interior Cold		長 Cháng	Long	Excess · past positions	
RHYTHM GROUP				短 Duǎn	Short	Qi def/stag · one position	
結 Jié	Knotted	Slow + irreg. skips		⚠ Key Distinctions to Know Wiry vs Tight: Wiry = taut violin string · Tight = twisted rope (colder, more pain) Slippery vs Flooding: Slippery = smooth rolling (normal width) · Flooding = large surging wave Scattered vs Floating: Scattered = floating but rootless, disperses on pressure — critical sign Moving 動: Short, slippery, rapid bead — felt only at Guan — pain or extreme fright 代 Dài = worst rhythm: regular fixed-interval skips = organ Qi declining ⚠			
促 Cù	Hurried	Rapid + irreg. skips					
代 Dài	Reg. Intermittent	Slow + fixed gaps ⚠					
動 Dòng	Moving	Pain · fright · Guan only	acute hip/ankle injury				
RATE GROUP				數 Shuò	Rapid	>5/resp — Heat	Cha Cha/Mambo heat
遲 Chí	Slow	<4/resp — Cold					
疾 Jí	Racing	>7/resp — extreme Heat					
緩 Huǎn	Moderate	4/resp — Damp/normal	heavy legs in Rumba				
STRENGTH GROUP				實 Shí	Full	Excess — forceful all levels	peak Mambo energy
虛 Xū	Empty	Def — weak all levels					
弱 Ruò	Weak	Deep + fine + soft					
微 Wēi	Frail	Barely perceptible	hitting the wall at comp				

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